

SKIN

If you could unwrap your skin, you might be surprised at how much you have—enough to cover a large towel. It goes over all your bumps and curves, and into every crease of your body. Your skin grows with you, so that when you are an adult it will cover an area of about 5.6 square feet (1.7 square meters). It is waterproof and protective, and can heal itself if it gets damaged.

Personal prints

Fingerprints are patterns of lines and swirls on your fingers. Try printing yours using paint or ink! Everyone has different fingerprints, so they are used to identify people. There are three basic patterns.



Arch



Loop



Whorl

A fingernail takes about six months to grow from base to tip. It grows about 0.02 inches (half a millimeter) a week.

Nails are made of dead cells which contain a protein called keratin.

The cuticle is the fold of skin overlapping the nail bed from where the nail grows.

The half moon at the base of your nail looks white because this part is not firmly attached to the skin below.

Hairs grow on every part of your skin except for your lips, the palms of your hands, and the soles of your feet.

New skin grows all the time to replace old skin that rubs off. Most house dust is really old, dead skin!

The thinnest skin is on your eyelids.

